

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 6 3
 ♥ 9 8 6 4 3
 ♦ Q 10
 ♣ J 5 4 2

♠ A J 10

♥ Q 10 7

♦ K J 6

♣ A K 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 8 5

♥ A 2

♦ 9 7 5 4 2

♣ Q 9

♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ K J 5

♦ A 8 3

♣ 10 7 6

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

You dealt this hand.

This would be an ideal hand to open 1NT - well, it would be with one less point. But with 18 you are too strong to open 1NT so you open 1♣. Partner responds 1♠.

DO NOT fall into the trap of supporting partner's ♠s just because you have such nice help for him. He might have a 4-card suit. Instead, just describe your hand by jumping to 2NT, showing a balanced hand with 18-19 points. Partner now bids 3NT and you play it there.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q J 6
 ♥ A K 7
 ♦ Q 8 6 4
 ♣ A K 8

♠ 5 3

♥ 10 6 3 2

♦ J 10 9 5

♣ Q J 2



♠ K 10 9 7 4 2

♥ Q J 5

♦ 3

♣ 7 4 3

♠ A 8

♥ 9 8 4

♦ A K 7 2

♣ 10 9 6 5

West

1 ♦

2NT

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

North

Pass

Pass

East

1 ♠

3 ♠

South

Pass

Pass

You dealt this hand.

You open 1 ♦ and partner responds 1 ♠. What is your next bid?

Do not support what may be a 4-card suit with only 3 cards. Instead, jump to 2NT, showing 18-19, balanced. Partner rebids the ♠s. What do you say next?

Partner shows a minimum hand, but with 6 ♠s. 3NT is very tempting, and might work out fine, but with 9 ♠s it is probably better to play the suit game. So you bid 4 ♠ and everybody passes.

Bidding 4 ♠ was a good choice. It makes easily, yet 3NT might have gone down.